Mariella Sinderhaud

29.01.2026

Sales pitch

KÜHNE LOGISTICS UNIVERSITY

Leading with an Operations Mindset

The Talent & Innovation Trap

The Real threat in today's world

- Traditional hiring is expensive, slow, and often misses the mark. Resumes don't show resilience.
- Consulting firms sell you **expensive slides**, but your internal teams struggle to **execute.**
- Your workforce needs rapid **upskilling & innovation**, but standard training is **too generic.**

“

- **Validation?**

We validate your ideas in a safe, neutral environment before you commit capital.

- **Hiring?**

Stop reading resumes. We put talent to work on your challenges so you can see them in action.

- **Execution?**

Stop generic training. We upskill your teams by having them solve real problems while earning accredited certifications.

The Solution

Meet KLU EIH: Your Innovation partner

We are not just a university. We drive Innovation

Why us?

- **Top-tier Talent:**

Access to 500+ hand-picked students from diverse, international backgrounds.

- **Reseach Power:**

A world-class research ecosystem that turns academic theory into your competitive advantage.

- **Proven Output:**

Our graduates are recruited by the biggest names in the industry.

Our Offerings

The selection differs in level of committment, departments involved & duration

Hackathon

Innovation Challenges

Student Advisory Board

Student Focus

Industry Focus

Beyond now

Research2Venture

Micro-certificates

From Student Energy to Business Impact

Hackathon

Innovation challenges

Student advisory board

Talent pipeline

Meet & recruit young talents

Fresh Insight

Use innovation feedback & fresh ideas

Brand visibility

Enhance reputation & visibility

Business solutions

Solutions for your company challenges

Hackathon

What ?

Teams work on a **scoped challenge** or a case study proposed **by the company** in a competitive setting. Students deliver a prototype and a short pitch at the end of the event; **follow-up for winner** team or student.

Format

- Online & On-campus
- 4 to 48 hours Reapatable

Participants

30 to 50 students & 3 mentors/judges

- **Build usable prototypes, fast**

Move **from ideas to tangible concepts** (prototype / mockups + pitch) you can **reuse internally** and push into execution.

- **Validate before you invest**

Test assumptions quickly and leave with a ranked shortlist to **prioritize investment** with confidence.

- **Recruit while you innovate**

Identify **top profiles** in real conditions and position your company as a partner of innovation: **high visibility, low time cost.**

Innovation Challenge

What ?

Structured consulting engagements where a selected student team works on a defined **business**, **strategy**, **innovation** challenge provided by a corporate partner. Students analyze a **concrete problem**, **develop solutions**, and deliver defined **outputs.**

Format

- Hybrid/ Remote
- 3–6 Months

Participants

4–6 Selected Students +

1 Faculty Supervisor

- **Specialized consulting at a fraction of cost**

Move from ideas to tangible concepts (prototype / mockups + pitch) you can reuse internally and push into execution.

- **Potential Hiring in real-world setting**

Assess their **problem-solving skills**, **cultural fit**, and **work ethic** over an entire project lifecycle

Student Advisory Board

What ?

A **semester-long advisory relationship with selected KLU students** to advise your company on key challenges. **Insight-driven collaboration** involving **knowledgeable young talents** based on specific qualifications.

Format

- Online & On-campus
- Monthly sessions over 1 semester

Participants

6 to 10 students & 2 employees

- **Get a semester of actionable insights**

For a semester, a selected student team delivers structured analysis and recommendations on your key challenges: **fresh, research-backed, and actionable.**

- **Recruit from a pre-tested talent pool**

Identify **high-potential profiles** over time (not in a 30-minute interview) and **convert the best contributors** into interns / graduates.

From Student Energy to Business Impact

Beyond Now

Research2Venture

Micro-Certificates

Partner Network

Enhance industry Collaboration

Ecosystem access

Enrich a dynamic ecosystem

Focused upskilling

Equip your teams for future success

Expert insights

Gain industry experts perspectives

Beyond Now

What ?

A full-day **innovation lab** where companies bring a real, future-facing challenge and co-create **visionary scenarios**, concepts, and roadmaps with **students, faculty, and future modeling experts.**

Format

- Online, Innovation lab
- 1 full day

Participants

100+ students
50+ experts
10+ companies

- **Explore disruptive solutions beyond short-term constraints**

Move beyond incremental innovation by testing bold scenarios grounded in structured futures thinking.

- **Strengthen innovation culture and employee mindset**

Teams experience new tools (future modeling, design thinking, foresight) they can reuse internally.

- **Access top talent and fresh perspectives**

Work directly with high-potential students and PhDs on your own strategic challenges.

Research2Venture

What ?

A networking event where **PhD students showcase their research** in a **concise way.** In a marketplace booth format that allows recruiters to **discover PhD students works** and further explore **concrete venture ideas.**

Format

- On-campus, with exhibition stands
- 2 events/year 5 hours event

Participants

- 10 to 20 Phd students

- **Spot the next technology first**

Get first look at cutting-edge research and emerging technologies, before they reach mainstream markets.

- **Create real partnership & licensing dealflow**

Source concrete opportunities (collab / PoC / licensing / investment) through a curated marketplace format designed for conversion.

- **Recruit PhD talent efficiently**

Meet PhD-level profiles and assess expertise quickly in a structured setting—ideal for R&D hiring and specialized roles.

Micro-Certificates

What ?

Co-designed innovation micro-certificates that build capabilities: combining **academic rigor & real cases, tools, and data.** You can participate into a short curriculum with other companies for your **teams upskilling & networking.**

Format

- Online & On-campus
- 4–6 weeks delivery

Participants

30 to 50 students & 3 mentors/judges

- **Employer branding and talent retention**

Recognized micro-certificates enhance employee motivation, retention, and positioning as a learning-oriented employer.

- **Upgrade skills faster: with academic rigor**

Access university-level expertise and proven frameworks to accelerate learning curves and improve decision quality across teams.

- **Benchmark and learn with peers**

Benchmark practices with peer companies, exchange methods, and build a network that supports continuous improvement beyond the program.

To wrap up

- Choose which solution fits best for you
- Visualize how KLU EIH can help you grow
- Design your ideal partnership with us

Get on board & get in touch!

Entrepreneurship & Innovation Hub KLU
Mariella Sinderhauf
Entrepreneurship@klu.org
+49 1602511104

KLU KÜHNE LOGISTICS UNIVERSITY

Leading with an Operations Mindset